



AFTER

In Europe, the British Prime Minister Lord Palmerston and the French Emperor Napoleon III had been cautiously sympathetic toward the Confederates.

EUROPE BACKS AWAY

News of the Emancipation Proclamation, along with Southern general Robert E. Lee's retreat from Maryland, changed the minds of Lord Palmerston and the British cabinet. They **postponed plans to recognize Confederate independence** and offer mediation. The British Empire, which had freed its enslaved populations in 1833, **could not morally support a slaveholding republic** against a nation that fought to make men free. France followed Britain's lead.



BRITISH PRIME MINISTER
PALMERSTON